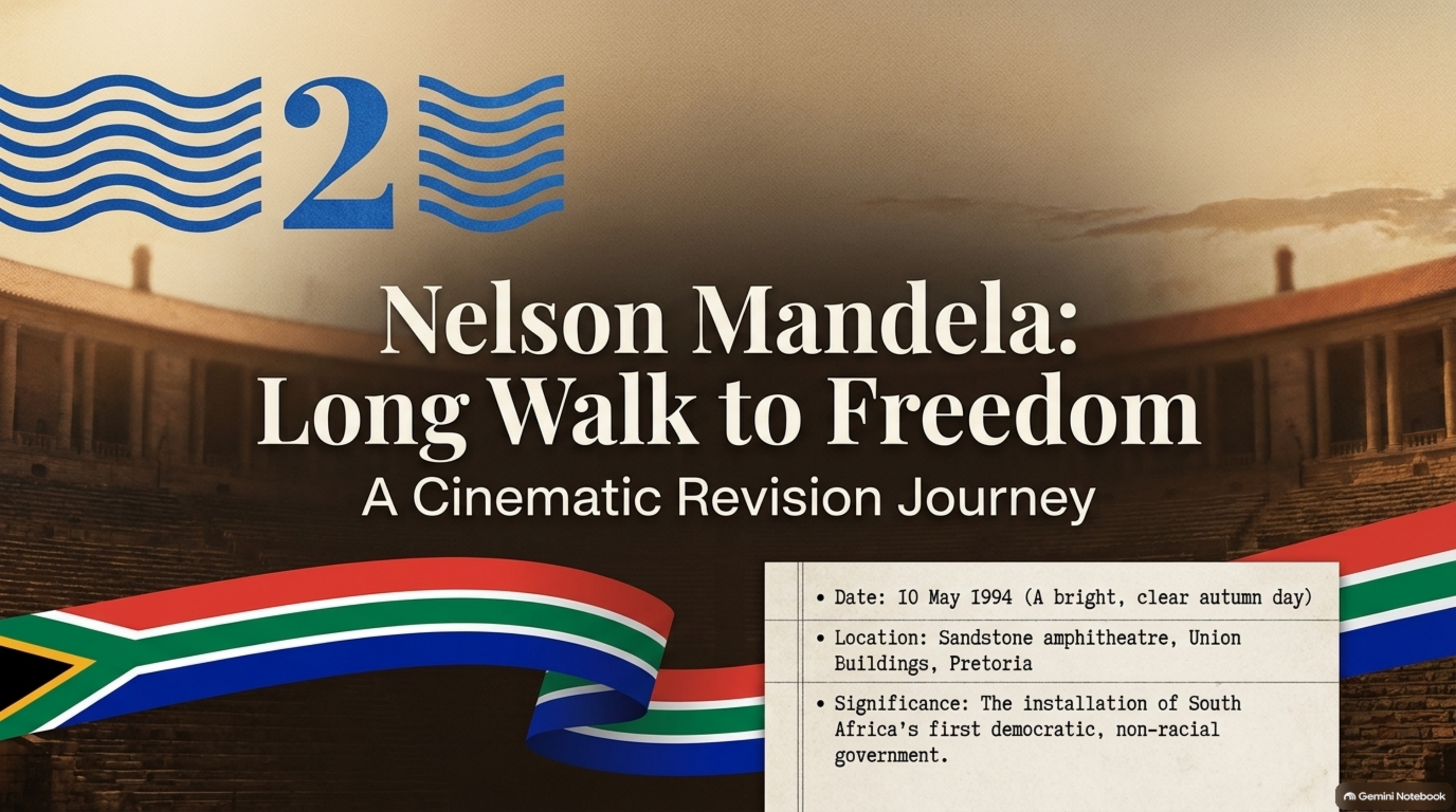
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Nelson Mandela:
Long Walk to Freedom
A Cinematic Revision Journey
• Date: 10 May 1994 (A bright, clear autumn day)
• Location: Sandstone amphitheatre, Union Buildings, Pretoria
• Significance: The installation of South Africa's first democratic, non-racial government.
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10 May 1994: The Dawn of Liberty

Zenani: Mandela's daughter, accompanying him.

Mr de Klerk: Sworn in as second deputy president.

Thabo Mbeki: Sworn in as first deputy president.

The Atmosphere

- A rainbow gathering of international leaders.
- Military loyalty: Generals with medals from days gone by saluting, not arresting him.
- Spectacular array: A chevron of Impala jets leaving a smoke trail of the new flag.

Two Anthems

Whites:	Blacks:
'Nkosi Sikelel -iAfrika'	'Die Stem' (the old anthem they once despised).

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The Weight of History

Core Emotion:
Overwhelmed with a sense of history.

"I was simply the sum of all those African patriots who had gone before me."

He felt a deep pain that he could not thank the thousands who sacrificed before him.

He was sad they could not see what their unimaginable sacrifices had wrought (achieved).

That long and noble line ended and now began again with him.

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The Dark Past: The Apartheid System

Definition:

A political system of racial domination erected by white-skinned peoples against the dark-skinned peoples of South Africa.

Origins:

Created in the first decade of the twentieth century, after the Anglo-Boer war.

The Impact

- Formed the basis of one of the harshest, most inhumane, societies the world has ever known, world has ever known.
- Created a deep and lasting wound that will take generations to heal.

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Childhood: The Illusion of Freedom

"I was born free — free in every way that I could know."

The Realization: As long as he obeyed his father and his tribe, he thought he was free. He only discovered later as a young man that his freedom was just an illusion.

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The Evolution of Freedom

Step 1: The Student

Transitory Freedoms

- Wanted freedom only for himself.
- Being able to stay out at night.
- Read what he pleased and go where he chose.

Step 2: The Young Man

Honourable Freedoms

- Wanted the basic freedom of achieving his potential.
- Earning his keep, marrying, having a family.
- Not being obstructed in a lawful life.

Step 3: The Leader

Indivisible Freedom

- Joined the African National Congress (ANC).
- Realized the chains on anyone of his people were the chains on him.
- Freedom is indivisible.

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The Struggle and The Sacrifice

The Great Patriots:
Oliver Tambo, Walter Sisulu, Chief Luthuli

> "The Paradox: *Decades of brutal oppression unintentionally produced men of extraordinary courage. Depths of oppression create such heights of character.*

Mandela's Transformation

Frightened young man → Bold one

Law-abiding attorney → Criminal

Family-loving husband → Man without a home (a monk)

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What is Courage?

Courage ≠ Absence of Fear

Courage = The Triumph Over Fear

The Brave Man: *The brave man is not he who does not feel afraid, but he who conquers that fear.*

The Glimmer of Humanity

- Even pushed to their limits in prison, Mandela saw humanity in the guards.
- Insight: Man's goodness is a flame that can be hidden but never extinguished.

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The Twin Obligations

Obligation 1:
To family, parents, wife, and children.

Obligation 2:
To his people, his community, and his country.

The Apartheid Reality

- In a humane society, a man can fulfill both.
- In South Africa, trying to serve the people meant being ripped from family.
- Forced to live a twilight existence of secrecy and rebellion.

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Freedom For All: A Dual Liberation

The oppressor must be liberated just as surely as the oppressed.

The Oppressed

- Prisoner of physical chains.
- Freedom is stolen from them.

The Oppressor

- Prisoner of hatred.
- Locked behind the bars of prejudice and narrowmindedness.

Both the oppressed and the oppressor alike are robbed of their humanity.

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Key Ideas & Universal Messages

Mandela's Core Beliefs

True Wealth

South Africa is rich in minerals and gems. But its greatest wealth is its people, finer and truer than the purest diamonds.

Love vs. Hate

No one is born hating another person because of skin color. People must learn to hate. If they can learn to hate, they can be taught to love, because love comes more naturally to the human heart.

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Decoding Important NCERT Lines

Depths of oppression create such heights of character.

Meaning: Extreme suffering and brutality force people to develop unimaginable courage, wisdom, and resilience to fight back.

A twilight existence of secrecy and rebellion.

Meaning: A half-secret, isolated life lived in the shadows, away from family and normal society, focused only on fighting the government.

I was not unmindful of the fact...

Meaning: I was highly conscious and fully aware of the reality (that the same generals saluting him today would have arrested him years ago).

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Super Revision Timeline

The Dark Origin

Early 20th Century: The harsh Apartheid system is erected after the Anglo-Boer War.

The Boyhood Illusion

Childhood: Believing he was born completely free as long as he obeyed his tribe.

The Awakening

Youth: Realizing his freedom was an illusion; hungering for transitory and honourable freedoms.

The Greater Hunger

Adulthood: Joining the ANC; realizing freedom is indivisible; the struggle begins.

The Triumph

10 May 1994: The inauguration of the first democratic, non-racial government.

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Board-Oriented Vocabulary

Emancipation: Freedom from restriction or political control.

Context: South Africa finally achieving political emancipation.

Deprivation: The state of not having one's rightful benefits or basic needs.

Context: Liberating people from poverty and deprivation.

Resilience: A great ability to remain unchanged by suffering and recover from hardship.

Context: The unimaginable resilience of the patriots.

Transitory: Not permanent; lasting only a short time.

Context: The temporary freedoms of a student staying out late.

Prejudice: A strong, unreasonable dislike or hatred without good reason.

Context: The oppressor is locked behind bars of prejudice.

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Exam Booster: Master Questions

Short Answer (2-3 Marks)

Q: What are the twin obligations?

Ans: Obligation to family (parents, wife, children) AND obligation to people/country. Apartheid made it impossible to fulfill both.

Long Answer (5-6 Marks)

Q: How did Mandela's understanding of freedom change with age?

Ans: From childhood illusion (running/swimming) -> Student's transitory freedom (staying out) ->Young man's basic freedom (earning/family) -> Leader's indivisible freedom (freedom for all his people).

Value-Based

Q: Why does Mandela say the oppressor is not free?

Ans: Because the oppressor is a prisoner of hatred and prejudice. By stealing someone's freedom, they are robbed of their own humanity. Both must be liberated.

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